

1. GAME OVERVIEW

- Players: 3-6. Build hotel chains, purchase stock, trigger mergers, and collect shareholder payouts.
- The winner is the player with the most money after final bonuses and stock sales.
- A normal turn always follows the same order: play a tile, buy stock, then draw a tile.

2. SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- Place the 7 hotel-chain markers face up at the end of the board. Turn all 108 hotel tiles face down and randomize them.
- Choose a banker. Give each player \$6,000: four \$1,000 bills, three \$500 bills, and five \$100 bills.
- Each player draws and places 1 starting tile. The tile closest to row A goes first; ties use proximity to space 1A. Leave these tiles on the board.
- Each player draws 6 hidden tiles. Keep stock certificates and bank money accessible.

3. TYPICAL TABLE SETUP





4. TURN SEQUENCE

- 1) Play 1 tile from your hand onto its matching board space. Resolve founding, growth, merger, or no effect.
- 2) Buy up to 3 stock certificates total. Buy only stock in chains currently on the board; purchases may be split among chains.
- 3) Draw 1 random face-down tile, returning your hand to 6 tiles.
- If no tile in your hand is legal, reveal and set aside the hand, draw 6 new tiles, then continue the turn.

5. FOUNDING, GROWTH & SAFETY

- Found a chain by placing a tile orthogonally next to an unincorporated tile. Choose an unformed chain and receive 1 free founder stock if available.
- Grow a chain by placing a tile orthogonally next to that chain. Chain size determines prices and merger bonuses.
- A chain with 11 or more tiles is safe and cannot be acquired. A tile that would merge two safe chains is illegal.
- If every chain is already active, a tile that would found another chain is illegal.

6. MERGER ORDER

- The largest chain survives; a tied merger is decided by the player who placed the merger tile.
- Pay primary and secondary shareholder bonuses for each acquired chain before stock decisions.
- In a multiple merger, resolve acquired chains one at a time, from largest to smallest.

7. ACQUIRED STOCK

- Starting with the merger player, each shareholder may hold, sell, or trade in any combination.
- Sell at the acquired chain's current price.
- Trade 2 acquired-chain shares for 1 surviving-chain share, if available. Held shares have no value unless the chain is founded again.

8. ENDING & SCORING

- After playing a tile, the active player may end the game if a chain has 41 or more tiles, or if every active chain is safe.
- Finish the current turn. Pay final shareholder bonuses, then sell all stock in active chains.
- Stock in chains not on the board is worthless. Most money wins; tied players share the victory.

MERGER CHECKLIST

1. Compare chain sizes.
2. Identify primary and secondary shareholders.
3. Pay bonuses.
4. Each player holds, sells, or trades acquired stock.
5. Remove the acquired chain marker.